

SANTIAGO

“The water flows where the money goes!”

A game of plantations, irrigation and bribery — Claudia Hely & Roman Pelek (AMIGO, 2003)
3-5 players · ages 10+ · about 60 minutes



Bananas



Sugar cane



Potatoes



Beans



Red peppers

The island of Santiago

What the game is about

- On the hot Cape Verde island of Santiago, every drop of water is precious.
- **Your goal:** Buy plantations at auction, join them into big same-crop areas, and get canals built to them — dry plantations crumble to desert.
- **The twist:** Canals go where the Canal Overseer wants. The Overseer listens to bribes.
- **Winning:** Most money at the end wins. Every Escudo spent must earn itself back.

Five crops to grow:



Bananas



Sugar cane



Potatoes



Beans



Red peppers

What's in the box

45 plantation tiles



Bananas



Sugar cane



Potatoes



Beans



Red peppers

9 per crop — with 1 or 2 planters in the corner

22 yield markers each



your stake in a plantation — one colour per player

15 canals · 1 spring



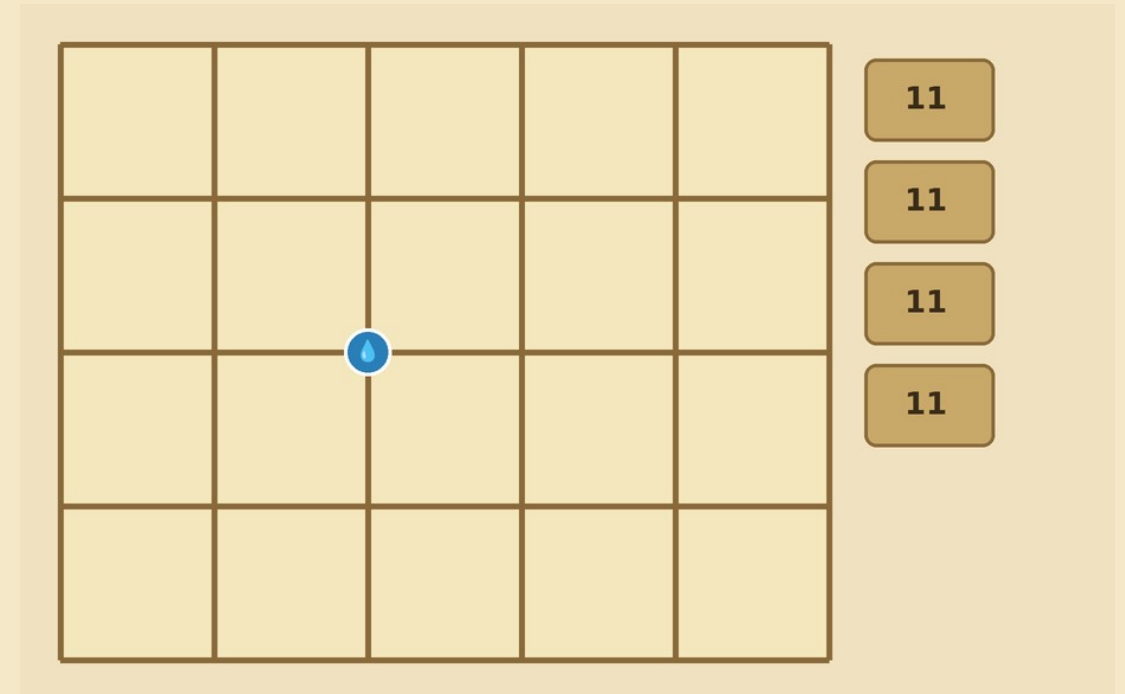
Escudos & the Canal Overseer



start with 10 — keep yoursdecides where water flows hidden!

Setting up

- **Spring:** Spring on any ditch intersection — the middle is friendlier.
- **Tiles:** 3–4 players: four face-down piles of 11 tiles (one tile removed). 5 players: five piles of 9.
- **Canals:** 11 canals by the board (9 with five players) + one personal “extra canal” each.
- **Players:** 10 Escudos, 22 markers and a proposal canal per player; someone random takes the Overseer figure.
- **Length:** 11 rounds (3–4 players) or 9 rounds (5) — exactly until all tiles are placed.



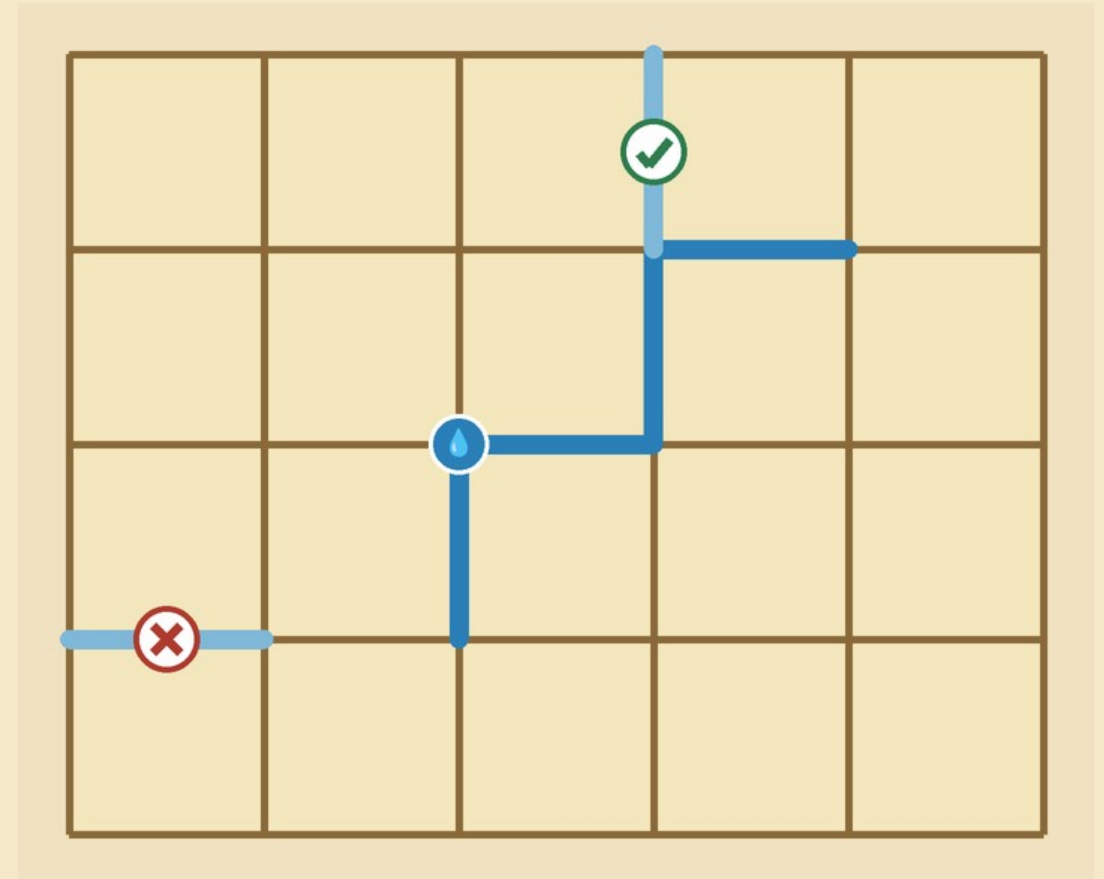
Board with the spring on a central intersection; face-down tile piles beside it

Key concept — building canals

- Canals lie on the brown ditch lines, always intersection to intersection.
- The network grows out from the spring — every new canal must touch the spring or an existing canal.
- Branching and loops are fine.



**Only 15 canals all game —
water is the scarcest resource**



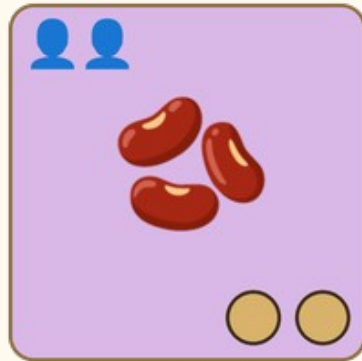
✓ touches the network — allowed. ✗ floats free of the network — not allowed.

Key concept — irrigation & yield markers

- Place a plantation, add your markers: one per planter shown on the tile.
- **Irrigated:** A plantation touching a canal on any side is irrigated — forever.

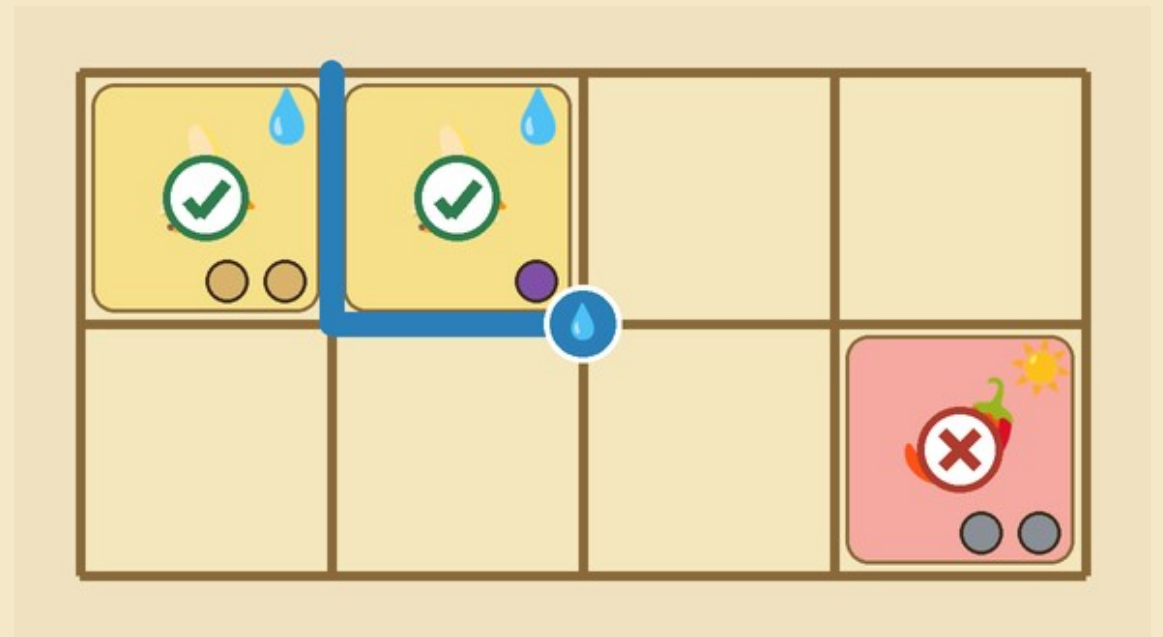


1 planter → 1 marker



2 planters → 2 markers

markers = your share of the harvest



Next to a canal: irrigated ✓ — cut off from the water: drying ✗

Key concept — connected areas

Where the money comes from

- Same-crop tiles touching side by side form one area — markers of several players can share it.
- Diagonal never counts; a canal running through does NOT split an area.
- **Value:** Area value for you = its tiles $\times$ your markers on it.

The 4-tile banana area is worth:

Beige: 4 tiles $\times$ 3 markers = 12 Esc

Purple: 4 tiles $\times$ 1 marker = 4 Esc

The diagonal banana belongs to a different area.



One 4-tile banana area (canal through it and a neutral tile included) — the X tile touches only diagonally

A round at a glance

Seven phases, always in this order

-  **1 Reveal & bid** — one open bid each — or pass
-  **2 New Overseer** — lowest bid (or first pass) takes the figure
-  **3 Take & place tiles** — highest bidder picks first
-  **4 Bribe the Overseer** — one canal gets built
-  **5 Extra irrigation** — one player may use their extra canal
-  **6 Drying** — dry plantations suffer (skip in last round)
-  **7 Income** — everyone collects 3 Escudos (skip in last round)

Phases 1-2 — the auction

One bid each, no second chances

- Flip one tile per pile, then everyone bids once, openly — or passes.
- **Unique bids:** Every bid must be a NEW amount — bidding lower is allowed. All bids go to the bank, win or lose.
- **Consolation:** Lowest bid — or the first passer — becomes the new Canal Overseer.

Bernd

5 Esc

picks first

Dagmar

4 Esc

picks 2nd

Anika

1 Esc

picks 3rd

Chris

PASS

picks last



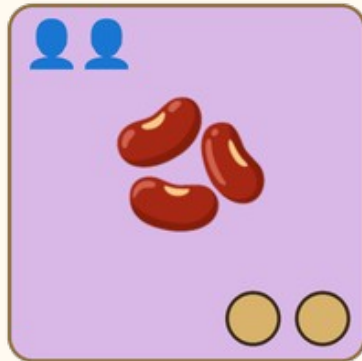
new Overseer!

High bid = first pick of land. Low bid = power over the water.

Phase 3 — take & place plantations

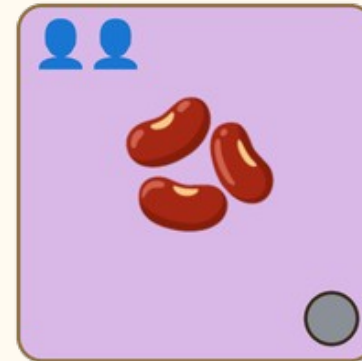
- In descending bid order: take one revealed tile, place it on any free square, add your markers.
- **Penalty:** Passed players place one marker fewer than the planters shown.
- **3 players:** With 3 players the leftover tile is placed neutral — no markers — next to another plantation.

You bid



2 planters → your 2 markers

You passed



2 planters → only 1 marker

Phase 4 — bribe the Canal Overseer

The heart of the game



Propose a canal + a bribe of 1+ Esc, placed openly



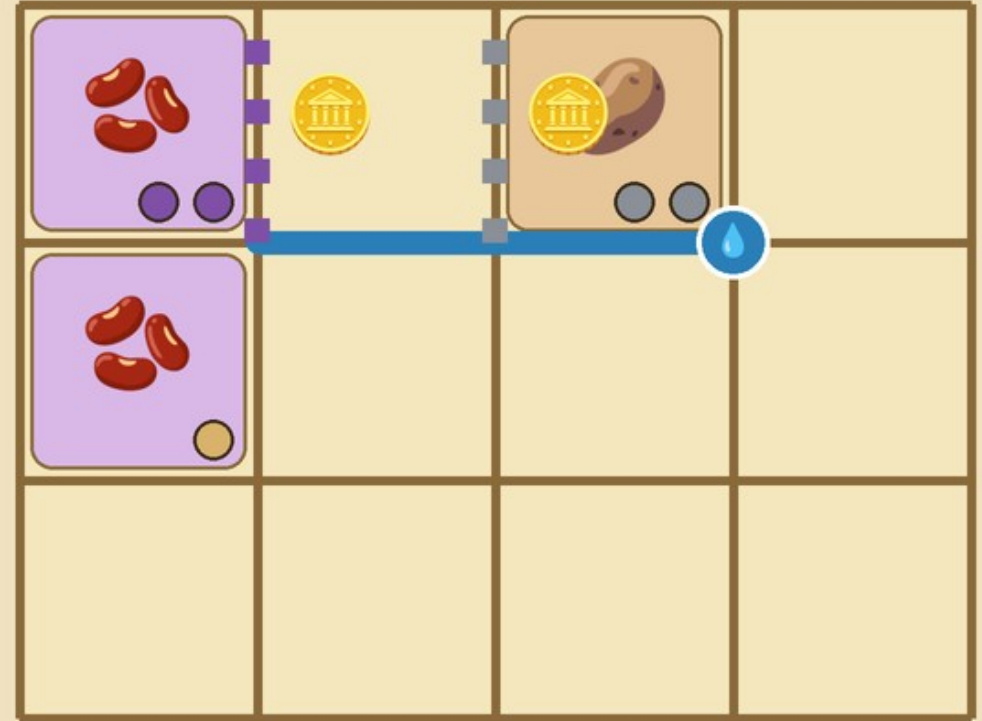
Support someone's proposal with 1+ Esc more



Pass and keep your money

The Overseer then either **accepts ONE proposal** — any one! — and pockets its bribe...

...or **builds anywhere else**, paying the bank 1 Esc more than the highest bribe. Losing bribes are returned.



Two proposals (dashed, with bribes): Purple wants the beans watered, Gray the potatoes

Phases 5-7 — extra canal, drying, income



Extra irrigation — your ONE free canal for the whole game — only one player may build it per round

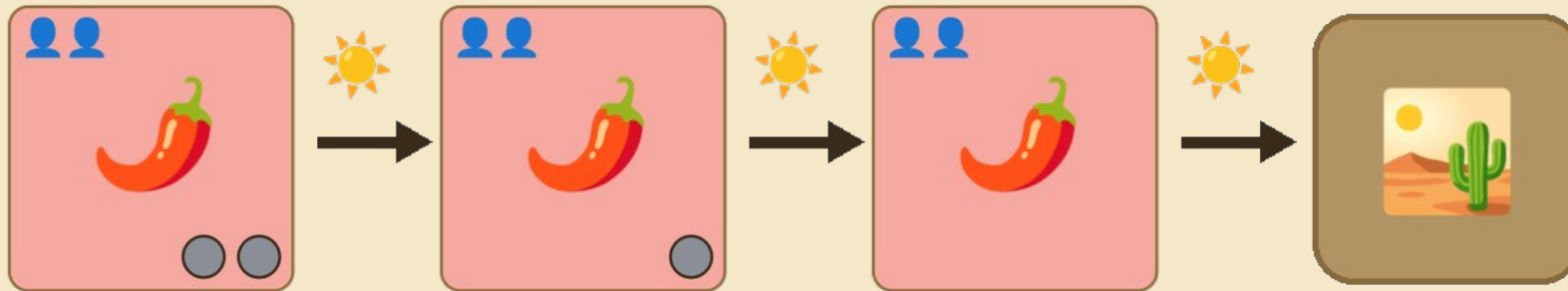


Drying — every plantation without a canal loses a marker; none left → desert



Income — everyone collects 3 Escudos

A plantation left dry, round after round:



...and desert can never be cultivated again. (Drying and income are skipped in the last round.)

Game end & scoring

After the last tile is placed

- **Final drought:** Everything still dry turns to desert — even with markers on it.
- **Score:** Keep your cash, then every area pays every player:

$$\boxed{\text{tiles in area}} \times \boxed{\text{your markers}} = \boxed{\text{Escudos}}$$

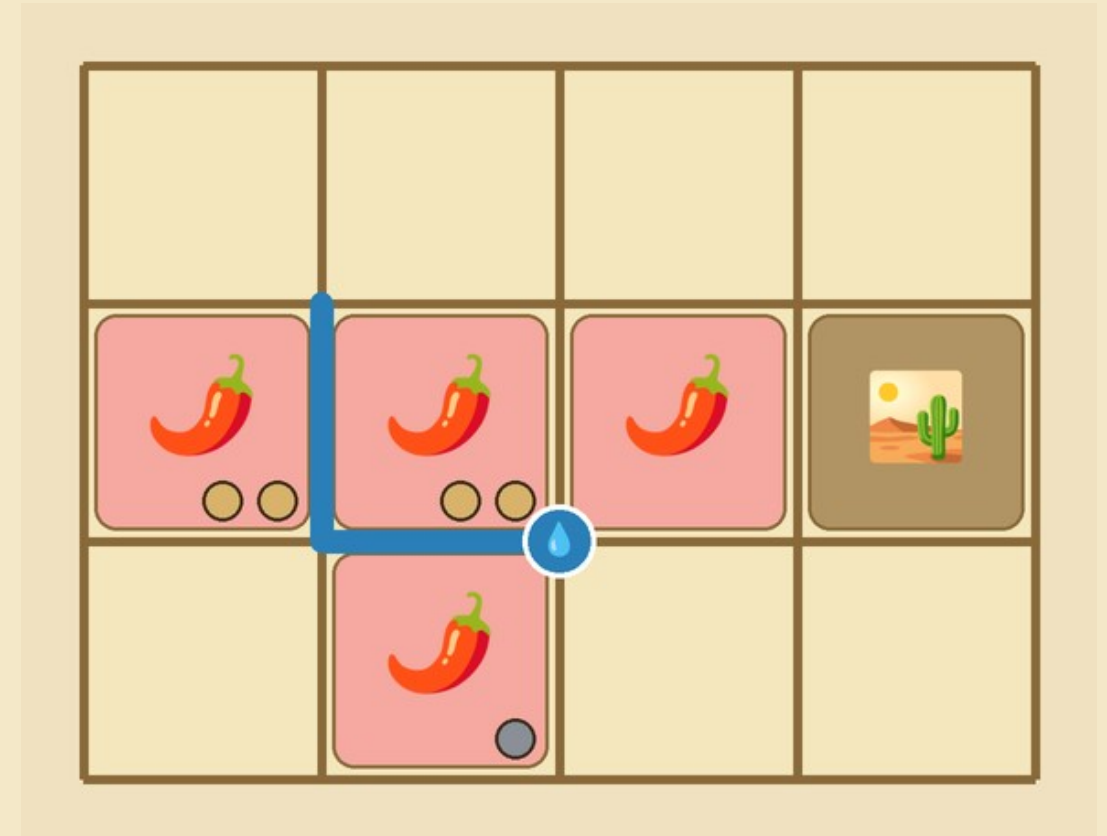
Beige: 4 tiles × 4 markers = 16 Esc

Gray: 4 tiles × 1 marker = 4 Esc

The desert tile pays nobody.



Most money wins!



Only irrigated, connected tiles pay — the flipped desert tile is gone for good

Tips for your first game



Water is scarce

only 15 canals all game — many fields
WILL become desert



Cheap bids buy power

the Overseer earns bribes and steers
the water



Check who profits

growing an area helps everyone with
markers on it



Save the extra canal

one per game — spend it where no
bribe will help



Play it online — asynchronously
budoludo.com/santiago



Personal secret links — no accounts, no passwords.
An email lands whenever it is your turn.